SAMUEL KIBET KETER, CCISO

Senior Cybersecurity Manager | Cloud Security & Compliance | GRC: ISO 27001 · SOC 2 · PCI DSS | 6 Markets · Teams up to 20 · Fintech & Banking

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity leader with 10+ years across banking, fintech and consulting. Promoted to Staff Engineering Manager at Yassir within 20 months for owning the enterprise-wide security program end to end — built the ISO 27001 ISMS, led SOC 2 readiness and contained a high-severity incident in 4 hours with a runbook now used group-wide. Led cyber defense across 6 markets with a team of 20 at Equity Bank. Moved cloud security from quarterly manual review to continuous drift monitoring across 8 GCP environment groups.

KEY EXPERTISE & TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frameworks & Compliance: ISO 27001 | SOC 2 | PCI DSS | NIST CSF & 800-53 | SWIFT CSP & Attestation | GRC

Cloud & Ops: GCP · Security Command Center | Security Operations | Incident Response | Vulnerability Management | IAM | Supply Chain Security | AI Security Governance

Sectors: Fintech & Banking | Mobile Money & Cross-Border Payments | East African Banking Regulation

Tools: SIEM · Aikido · Imperva · FireEye · Nessus · Burp Suite · Azure

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineering Manager, Cloud Security & Compliance | Yassir

Remote | Apr 2026 – Present

- Own the enterprise-wide security program governing SecOps, GRC and engineering security across all business units; define strategic direction, build business cases for security investments, and report directly to the Head of Platform & Infrastructure (CTO).
- Directed end-to-end response to a high-severity security incident, from containment through recovery; authored the incident response runbook adopted group-wide.
- Secured the source-code platform: shipped an internal monitoring service with automated triage and an auditable decision log, enforced commit signing and branch protection across all repositories, and built custom static-analysis rules aligned to current supply-chain attack techniques.
- Completed a governance and risk audit of the cloud data estate, closing all critical control gaps ahead of the scheduled external audit.
- Deployed automated security posture checks across eight cloud environment groups, replacing quarterly manual reviews with continuous drift monitoring.
- Established enterprise AI security governance, securing 5 proprietary models with data protection and guardrails on AI services.

Engineering Manager, Cloud Security & Compliance | Yassir

Remote | Aug 2024 – Apr 2026

- Led SOC 2 readiness and established the ISO 27001 ISMS across the organization, developing the security policies, controls and audit evidence pipelines behind it.
- Led a team of 8 covering security engineering, SecOps and GRC delivery.
- Automated joiner/leaver access for 400+ employees and ran vulnerability management on Aikido within SLA.
- Ran vendor evaluation, selection and third-party risk reviews.

Senior Manager, Cyber Defense | Equity Bank

Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, DRC, Rwanda, South Sudan | Dec 2022 – Jul 2024

- Led cyber defense strategy across 6 markets with a team of 20, protecting core banking, digital banking and cross-border payments.
- Designed and executed incident response playbooks for core banking systems, cutting containment time from weeks to hours.
- Developed and implemented security policies and risk management compliant with ISO 27001, NIST and PCI DSS.
- Directed risk assessments, vulnerability management and vendor risk reviews, keeping remediation within SLA.
- Worked with regulators, IT leadership and risk teams to embed security controls across subsidiaries.
- Delivered security awareness training to 5,000+ employees, reducing phishing click-through rates across the group.

Manager, Cyber Security | KPMG East Africa

Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Ethiopia | May 2021 – Nov 2022

- Led 20+ cybersecurity maturity assessments and penetration tests for banks, telecoms and enterprises across 4 markets, identifying critical gaps and setting remediation plans clients executed.
- Led cross-border audit teams and standardized group-level assessment of financial institutions in East Africa; ran executive workshops for technical and business stakeholders.

Manager, Cyber Security Assurance | Equity Bank

6 markets | Jun 2020 – Apr 2021

- Ran red team exercises and vulnerability assessments on banking systems; applied NIST 800-53 and data privacy controls across subsidiaries.
- Built executive security scorecards giving cross-subsidiary risk visibility to leadership.

Senior Associate, Risk Assurance (Cyber Security) | PwC Kenya

Nairobi, Kenya | Jul 2018 – May 2020

- Led IT security audits, risk assessments and penetration tests for government agencies, banks and nonprofits; rolled out security frameworks and compliance programs for enterprise clients.

Associate, Risk Assurance (Cyber Security) | PwC Kenya

Nairobi, Kenya | Oct 2017 – Jun 2018

- Performed vulnerability assessments and penetration testing across systems, databases and network infrastructure.

Information Security Officer | Sidian Bank

Nairobi, Kenya | Jan 2016 – Sep 2017

- Ran day-to-day security operations: log and firewall monitoring, threat detection and enterprise risk assessments.

IT Assistant | K-Rep Bank

Nairobi, Kenya | Mar 2015 – Dec 2015

- Supported core banking IT operations: network monitoring, server and endpoint support.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science — Kabarak University, Kenya, 2014

CCISO (EC-Council, 2019) · CEH (EC-Council, 2016) · ITIL v3 (2016) · PRINCE2 Foundation (2021) · PRINCE2 Agile (2022)

COMMUNITY & RECOGNITION

Featured in CISO HQ "CISO Tips" (Sept 2026) and CISO Whisperer "CISO Diaries"; mentor on threat modeling, IAM hardening and zero trust.